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Toh 1179 · Derge Tengyur

Toh 1179 in the Tengyur is a hymn of praise in verse, known in Tibetan as a work attributed to the figure whose name renders roughly as "Glorious Zangpo, Renowned for Excellence in Dharma." No Sanskrit title is determinable from the available sources. The text belongs to the genre of devotional eulogy, offering homage to a great spiritual master — described as the son of a fully awakened Buddha, bearing the body of a Sugata, and serving as the sole lamp of the three worlds — whose boundless compassion, gnosis, and recollection of past and future lives are celebrated in flowing stanzas. The composition praises this master's supreme qualities, including his radiant loving affection, his tireless performance of enlightened activity, and his singular dedication to liberating even the most difficult to liberate. As Toh 1179, it is classed among the hymns and works of Indian authors preserved in the Tengyur, the collection of canonical treatises and commentaries that complement the Kangyur.

Homage to the Guru.

The speech of glorious Zangpo, renowned as excellence in Dharma.
The son of the fully awakened Buddha, possessing the body of the Sugata.
The sole lamp of the three worlds, the eye of the three realms of existence.
To one accomplished in gnosis and striving therein, I bow.

The source of compassion, performing the deeds of a Tathāgata.
The perfect guide, abiding in the state of mindful knowing and bliss.
Arisen into existence solely and certainly for the benefit of others.
To the very one who liberates the difficult to liberate, I bow.

Recollecting former lives, adorned with a supreme assemblage of excellent qualities, his body is supremely beautiful. Endowed with the adornment of gnosis, resplendent and vast in loving affection, he recollects future lives together with their lineages. Watering all beings with the gnosis-waters of the welfare of sentient beings and the unity of the three vehicles, empowering them like sovereign trees. To that mass of gnosis — the son of the Śākyas, possessing the qualities of the Sugata's body — I bow.

Having fully developed through all ten grounds, perfections, and the ten supreme virtues, reaching the far shore of the accumulation of merit. Having

attained the qualities of the ten powers, reaching the culmination of all accumulations. He who liberates the ocean of existence and beyond existence — to him I bow.

This is a praise to the one who has gone to the far shore of all accumulations — to the holy supreme guru's quintessential instructions in the great drum of the sacred Dharma, adorned with reasoning and beautifully arranged words, he who bears the name of a bodhisattva, the sprout of buddhahood, named Zangpo Drakpa, endowed with the cool nectar of compassion and gnosis, having reached the far shore of all assemblies. This was requested by the Śākya monk Gelek Palgön, who dwells at the extremity of the divine land, and was beautifully arranged by the Śākya monk of the land of Hariputra named Chökyi Nyima. It is called "Received on the Crown of the Head." May it be of benefit to myself and to all beings.

Through this merit of mine,
May I become a buddha in the future,
And may all sentient beings suffering in saṃsāra
Be established in nirvāṇa.

Translator's Notes

- The phrase "दिव्यदेशेऽजयत्य" literally means "dwelling at the far end of the divine land" and likely refers to a geographically peripheral region associated with a Sanskrit place-name transliterated as "Hariputra" — this appears to be a place name (possibly in the Kathmandu Valley or nearby region) rather than the personal name Śāriputra, given the context. The identification is not certain.

The title "冠に授けられた" — "Received on the Crown of the Head" — is an expression indicating that this text was received with the highest veneration, placing it on the top of the head as a mark of profound respect.

Zangpo Drakpa is the subject of the hymn, identified in the colophon as a bodhisattva-figure, likely a lama. The four stanzas constitute a formal praise poem in his honor, and the colophon clarifies the authorial and compositional roles: Gelek Palgön commissioned it; Chökyi Nyima arranged the text.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.